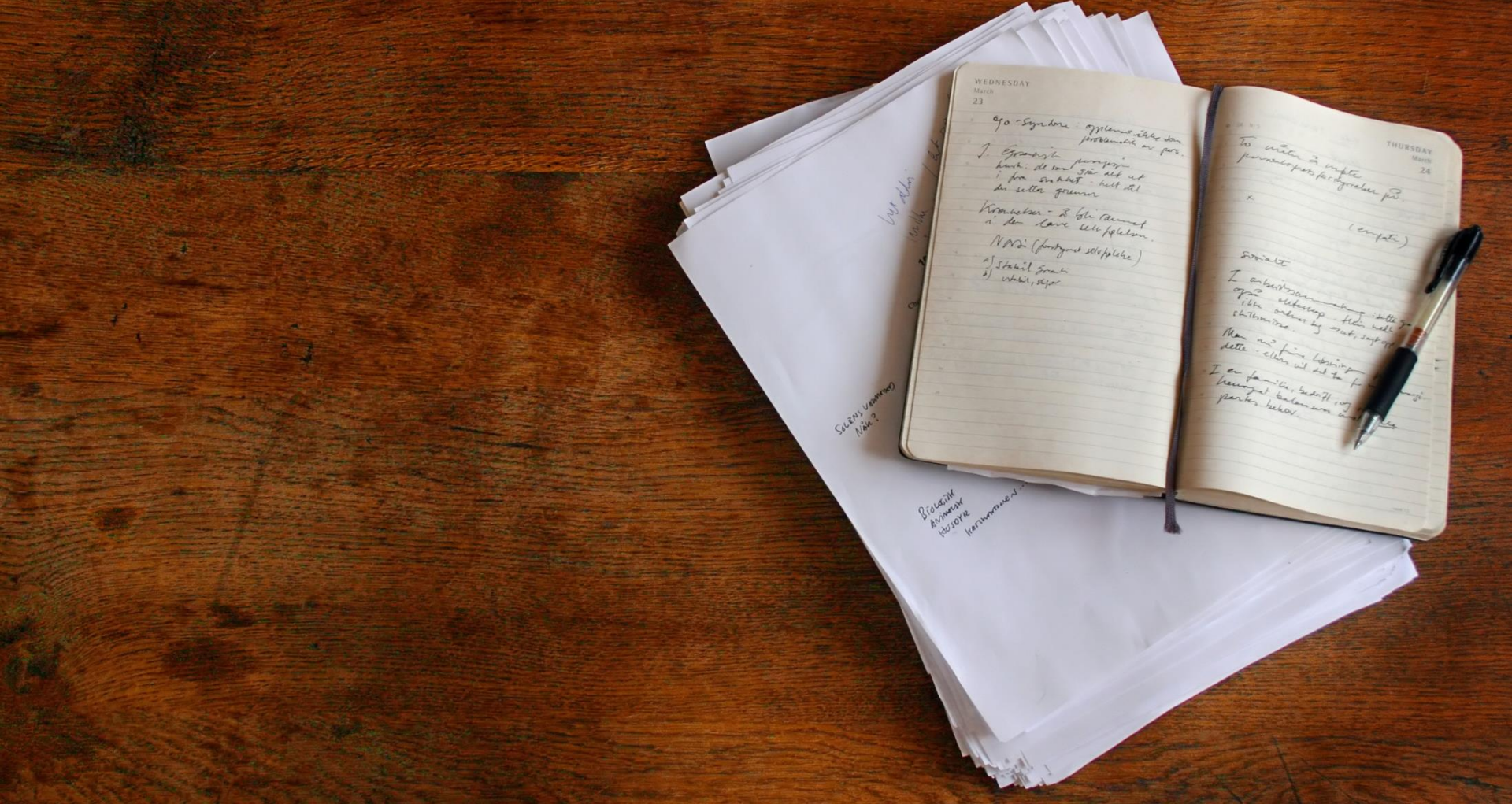




ACADEMIC WRITING (BETA) LECTURE, WEEK 1

Anna Martonfi
a.martonfi@vu.nl

Vrije Universiteit
Amsterdam

TODAY'S PROGRAMME

1. Why a course on academic writing?
2. What is academic writing?

INTRODUCTIONS

Dr Anna Martonfi

a.martonfi@vu.nl

Academic Language Programme

HWÆT WE EARDDE
 na in gear dagum. þeod cynninga
 þrym se frumon huda æþelingas elles
 fre medon. of seýld sceþing sceape
 þreatum monegū mæghum meodo secla
 of tearh ^{hæf} esode eorl syddan ariest pæp
 fea sceapz funden he þæs þroffe seba
 peox under polenum peopð myndum þah
 oð þ him æghwyle þara ymb sittendia
 of eorl hron. pade hyran scolde zombair
 sylðan þæs god cynning. ðæm æftera pas
 æfter cenned zæong in gear dūm þone god
 sende folce to þroffe fýper ðearfe on
 gear þine ærdrigon aldon æse. lange
 hwile him þæs luf þre puldnes pealder
 porold arie for gear. beapule pas þre ne
 blæd mde sinant. seah ðes æfter.



**I CAN HAZ BAD GRAMAR BECUZ
 I ARE CUTE**



**BUT U SHULD TIPE
 PROPRLY**



WHY ACADEMIC WRITING?

Introduction to the
course

AIMS OF THE COURSE

- introduce students to the basic requirements of formal writing in English
- develop students' academic writing skills with regard to a) accuracy and b) clarity of expression.
- introduce students to the basic conventions of using sources through quoting and paraphrasing

COURSE CONTENT

The subjects covered in the course are the following:

- Academic style: formality, use of academic phrases
- Quoting, referring and avoiding plagiarism
- Structure: Introduction, thesis statement, paragraph structure
- Linguistic accuracy: grammar, vocabulary and punctuation
- Clarity of formulation: linking language, clause combining

For detailed schedule, check the course manual.

SOME PRACTICALITIES

- 1-hour lecture (all together), 2-hour seminar (in 10 groups)
- You can check which group you've signed up to (see VU-net/Canvas). Switching is only possible with teacher's permission.
- Obligatory attendance (check course manual for details; if there are any problems, contact your seminar teacher)
- There are no classes in weeks 5 and 8 of this period.
- You can find a detailed schedule on Canvas.

ASSIGNMENTS

Assignment 1, Introduction

a three-sentence introduction for your final paper

Assignment 2, Introduction and first body paragraph

a full introduction and the first body paragraph for your final paper

Assignment 3, Conclusion

a three-sentence conclusion for your final paper

Assignment 4, Final paper

a 1000-word essay on a topic of your own choice, related to your field, using at least three academic articles.

Check course manual for more detail; more specific instructions will be made available later in the course.

DEADLINES!

Assignment	Deadline		Per cent of the final mark
Assignment 1	Week 2, Tuesday 11 April	Pass/fail	Required
Assignment 2	Week 4, Friday 25 April	Grade	25%
Assignment 3	Week 6, Friday 9 May	Pass/fail	Required
Assignment 4	Week 8, Friday 23 May	Grade	75%

COURSE MATERIALS

English Language Support Online:

www.vu.nl/fgw/els-online

- Log on using your VU-net-ID
- Contains background info on the topics discussed in class, plus additional explanation of grammar issues.
- Will be part of how your essays are graded.

QUESTIONS?

- Course manual
- FAQs on Canvas
- Seminar teacher during seminars



https://lnu.se/ImageVault/publishedmedia/oixm5lq7c8886adf9nih/Hand_skriver.jpg

WHAT IS ACADEMIC WRITING?

Introduction to
academic writing



QUIZ

ACADEMIC TEXT, YES OR NO? (1)

The Boss Baby dethroned Disney's *Beauty and the Beast* at the US box office with a \$49m debut this weekend, handing star Alec Baldwin what President Donald Trump – to whom the lead character voiced by Baldwin has been compared – might call a “huge” opening.

Join at menti.com | use code 7981 5899

Text 1: Academic or non-academic?



- Academic
- Non-academic



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Choose a slide to present

Text 1: Academic or non-academic?



Text 2: Academic or non-academic?



Text 3: Academic or non-academic?



Text 4: Academic or non-academic?



ACADEMIC TEXT, YES OR NO? (1)

The Boss Baby dethroned Disney's *Beauty and the Beast* at the US box office with a \$49m debut this weekend, handing star Alec Baldwin what President Donald Trump – to whom the lead character voiced by Baldwin has been compared – might call a “huge” opening.

Source: *The Guardian* (newspaper, so not an academic text)

<https://www.theguardian.com/film/2017/apr/02/boss-baby-trump-beauty-beast-us-box-office>

ACADEMIC TEXT, YES OR NO? (2)

Pransky [11] has provided an interesting perspective for the different profiles a future robot companion could take providing the advantages and weaknesses of such a future companion.

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Text 2: Academic or non-academic



- Academic
- Non-academic



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Text 1: Academic or non-academic?



Text 2: Academic or non-academic?



Text 3: Academic or non-academic?



Text 4: Academic or non-academic?



ACADEMIC TEXT, YES OR NO? (2)

Pransky [11] has provided an interesting perspective for the different profiles a future robot companion could take providing the advantages and weaknesses of such a future companion.

Source: Dautenhahn et al., so this is an academic text.

<http://citeseerx.ist.psu.edu/viewdoc/download?doi=10.1.1.63.9643&rep=rep1&type=pdf>

ACADEMIC TEXT, YES OR NO? (3)

In theory, humans could be used for all types of recycling, says David Peck, professor in critical materials and circular cities at Delft University of Technology, but they are not necessarily jobs to wish on people. “This is dirty, dangerous and difficult work,” he says.

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Text 3: Academic or non-academic



- Academic
- Non-academic



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ACADEMIC TEXT, YES OR NO? (3)

In theory, humans could be used for all types of recycling, says David Peck, professor in critical materials and circular cities at Delft University of Technology, but they are not necessarily jobs to wish on people. “This is dirty, dangerous and difficult work,” he says.

Source: *The Guardian* (newspaper, so not an academic text)

<https://www.theguardian.com/sustainable-business/2017/mar/21/recycling-robots-ai-uks-decline-waste>

ACADEMIC TEXT, YES OR NO? (4)

Governments fret over traffic and other local nuisances that create filthy air. But research just published in *Nature* by Zhang Qiang, of Tsinghua University in Beijing, and an international team including environmental economists, physicists and disease experts, suggests the problem has a global dimension, too. Dr Zhang's analysis estimates that in 2007 [...] more than 3m premature deaths around the world were caused by emissions of fine particulate matter (known as PM_{2.5}, because the particles in question are less than 2.5 microns across).

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Text 4: Academic or non-academic



- Academic
- Non-academic



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ACADEMIC TEXT, YES OR NO? (4)

Governments fret over traffic and other local nuisances that create filthy air. But research just published in *Nature* by Zhang Qiang, of Tsinghua University in Beijing, and an international team including environmental economists, physicists and disease experts, suggests the problem has a global dimension, too. Dr Zhang's analysis estimates that in 2007 [...] more than 3m premature deaths around the world were caused by emissions of fine particulate matter (known as PM2.5, because the particles in question are less than 2.5 microns across).

Source: *The Economist* (magazine, so not an academic text)

<https://www.economist.com/news/science-and-technology/21719780-rich-countries-export-air-pollution-and-its-associated-mortality-they-import>

TO COMPARE...

Millions of people die every year from diseases caused by exposure to outdoor air pollution^{1, 2, 3, 4, 5}. Some studies have estimated premature mortality related to local sources of air pollution^{6, 7}, but local air quality can also be affected by atmospheric transport of pollution from distant sources^{8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18}. [...] Here we combine four global models to estimate premature mortality caused by fine particulate matter (PM_{2.5}) pollution as a result of atmospheric transport and the production and consumption of goods and services in different world regions. We find that, of the 3.45 million premature deaths related to PM_{2.5} pollution in 2007 worldwide, about 12 per cent (411,100 deaths) were related to air pollutants emitted in a region of the world other than that in which the death occurred, [...]

Source: *Nature*, scientific journal, so this is an academic text

<https://www.nature.com/articles/nature21712>



**SO, HOW TO RECOGNIZE AN ACADEMIC
TEXT?**

1. WHAT FORMAT AND STRUCTURE DO ACADEMIC TEXTS HAVE?

- Standard structure, conventionalized
- References
- 'Boring' layout

> More about this in weeks 3 (use of sources) and 2,4,6 (structure)

2. WHAT LANGUAGE AND STYLE IS USED IN ACADEMIC TEXTS?

- Formal (no errors, complete sentences)
- Objective, factual
- Impersonal

> More about this in this week's seminar and in week 7.

3. WHAT 'STORIES' DO ACADEMIC TEXTS TELL?



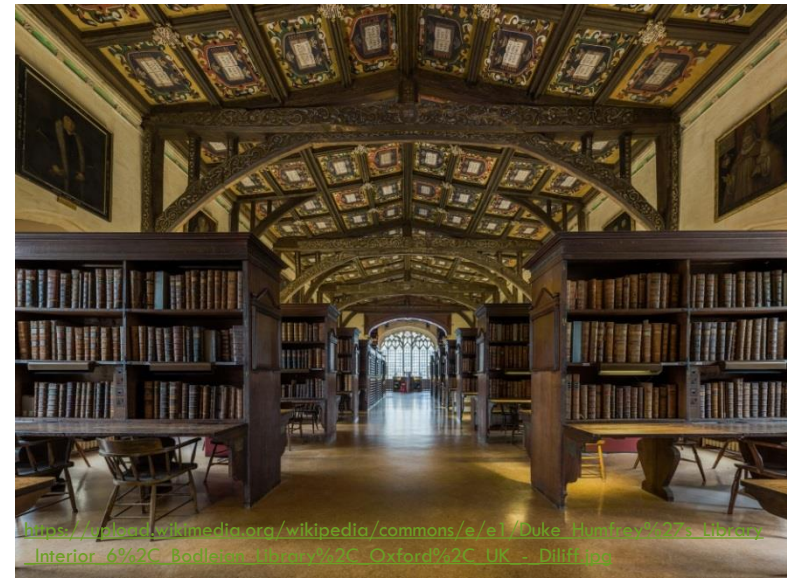
Solve a problem

Present a new idea

Find a solution

Explain what research has been done so far

Report on an experiment



A BRIEF NOTE ABOUT THE FINAL ASSIGNMENT

- The text you'll write for this course is similar to the background section of published papers: a (brief) review of the literature
- The type of text (essay) is not a format that you will come across in your reading, but the principles of structure and style are the same, so you can apply them in any text after this course.



THE TWO-MINUTE PAPER

Recap

THE TWO-MINUTE PAPER / OR: QUIZ TIME

Take a pen and paper or your laptop, and write down the answer to the following question:

1. How can you recognize whether a text is an academic text or not? Give at least 3 characteristics.

If that takes you less than two minutes, consider the following question:

2. In what situation during your BA/MA or after graduating will you be expected to write? What type of text could that be?

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How can you recognise if a text is academic or not?

All responses to your question will be shown here

Each response can be up to 200 characters long

Turn on voting to let participants vote for their favorites



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THE TWO-MINUTE PAPER — POSSIBLE ANSWERS

1. How can you recognize whether a text is an academic text or not? Give at least 3 characteristics.

Formal language, standard structure, references to other research, objective perspective, impersonal style

2. In what situation during your BA/MA or after graduating will you be expected to write? What type of text could that be?

In any case a BA and MA thesis, but also course papers. After graduating: reports for stakeholders (for instance about new software), internal company reports, etc.

COMING UP NEXT...

1. This week's seminar:

- Introduction to the course
- Features of academic writing
- Short writing assignment

2. Next week:

- Lecture: Structure of introductions
- Seminar:
 - Structure of introductions
 - Grammar issues
 - Instructions for assignment 1